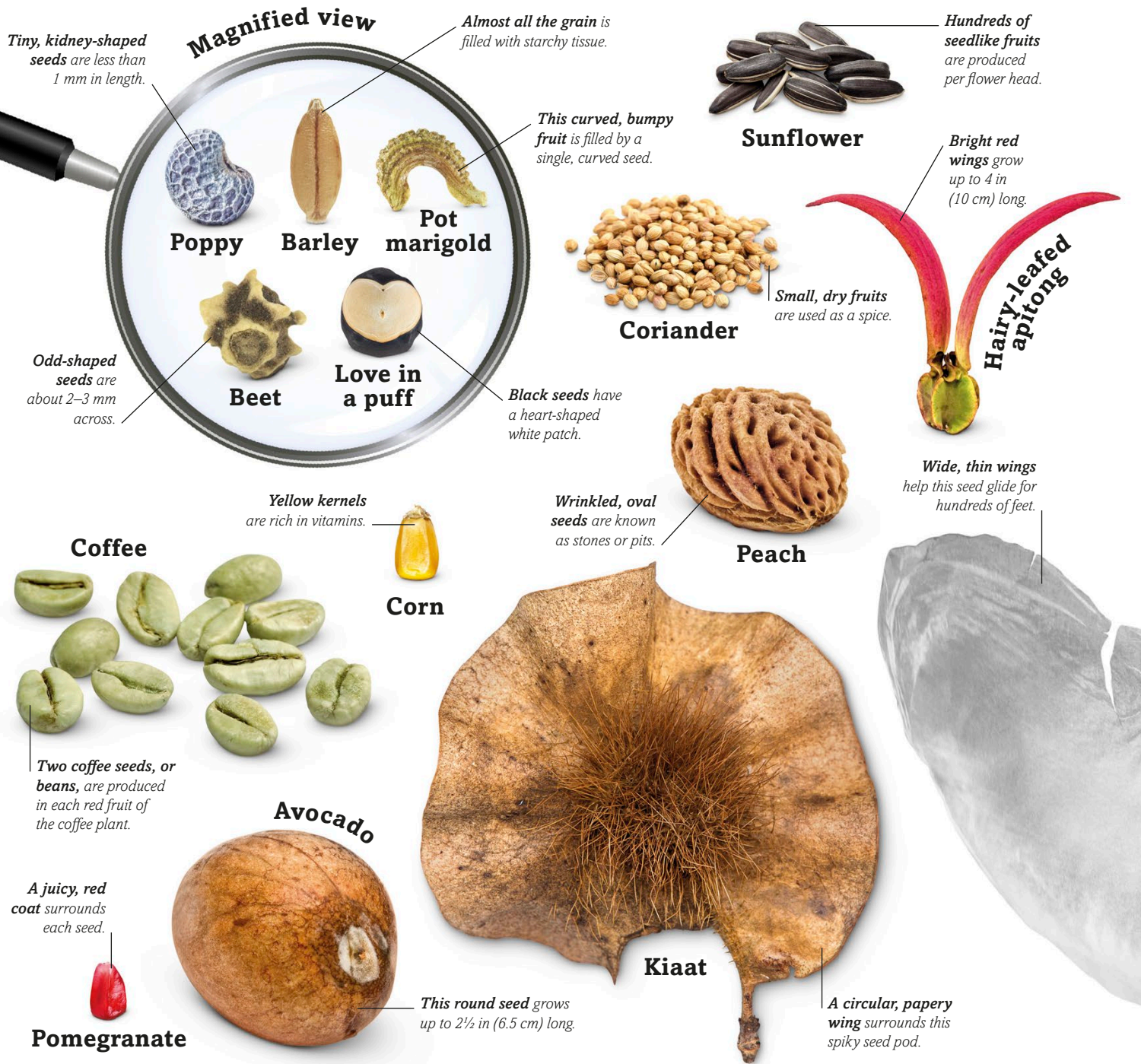




Seed shapes



A seed is a small package that protects a young plant and contains all the nutrients the plant will need to germinate. Although all seeds do the same job, they come in a wide range of shapes and sizes, to help each one survive in its particular environment and spread without being eaten by hungry animals.

The giant **coco de mer** seed is able to hold a lot of nutrients so that the new plant has enough energy to grow out of its mother's shadow. The **poppy** has another survival strategy—rather than one big seed, it produces tens of thousands of tiny seeds to maximize its chances. The spiky coats of the **horse chestnut** seed and the **kiaat** seed pod